

exponentially. You can find plenty of stories online, and members of your family probably have their own anecdotes—times your credit card was hacked or someone withdrew \$500 using your debit card number even though your debit card never left your possession. Explain to your daughter that many of today's thieves use something called skimming: they affix a small device to a bank machine or pay-at-the-pump terminal that reads the data from your card's magnetic strip when you swipe it. Later, these stolen card numbers are physically attached to substitute cards, which are then used to make purchases or withdraw money from your account. Scary stuff.

Make sure your daughter understands that you're not trying to scare her. You're simply trying to prepare her for the real world. She's not a baby anymore, and now that she has a bank card, she has to be ready to take preemptive action. Here are three tips for keeping her financial information safe:

1. Make sure the bank has your family's updated contact information. Most banks have gotten pretty good at flagging suspicious charges, but they can't ask you about one if they don't have your correct phone number and email address.
2. Stay away from bank machines that appear dirty or broken—these may be fake machines set up to capture card information. If a machine asks you to enter your PIN twice, cancel the transaction immediately.
3. Always cover the keypad when you key in your PIN. It'll keep you safe from wandering eyes and any cameras that may be watching.

Again, the best way for your daughter to protect herself against theft or fraud is to be constantly vigilant and financially aware.

Age 11

E.T.s: Entrepreneurs in Training

By 11, most kids get the itch to make money. Tommy down the street has a paper route; Tina babysits on the weekends. Your child, too, has probably expressed a desire to earn a little dough.